

DESIGN DIRECTION

Mythic Arena UI UX Blueprint

A practical visual and interaction system for a fast, readable 1v1 online card battle game.

Chosen direction

Tactical dark fantasy with premium motion

MotioSites-style cinematic depth belongs in the lobby, deck reveal, and match-intro moments.

The battle board should stay deliberately calm and information-first: dark surfaces, bright status color, strong hierarchy, and motion that never delays a decision.

VISUAL CHARACTER

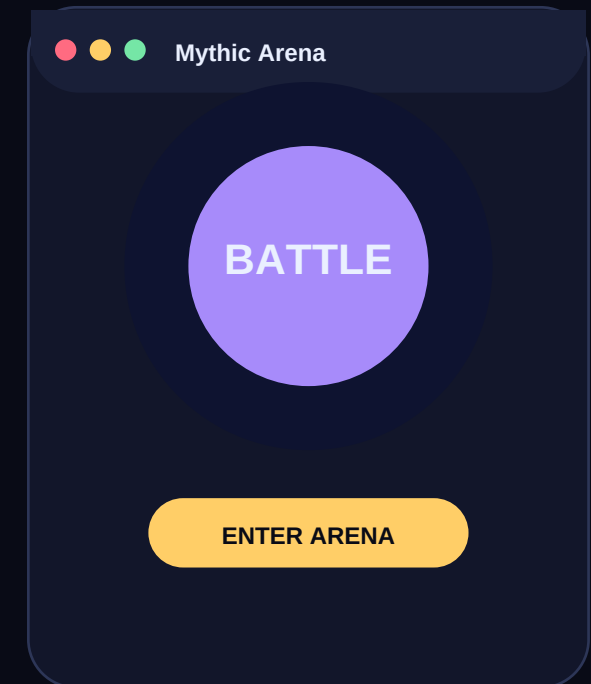
Midnight navy, mythic gold, icy cyan and violet glow

UX PRIORITY

Player always knows: whose turn, remaining time, energy and legal actions

MOTION PRINCIPLE

Make state changes feel alive; never make them harder to understand



VISUAL SYSTEM

The selected design language

Premium enough for a portfolio case study, clear enough for a competitive game.



Obsidian

App background



Night panel

Primary surface



Solar gold

Primary action



Arcane cyan

Information



Rune violet

Power and rarity



Ember red

Danger and enemy

Typography

Headlines: Space Grotesk or Sora | UI: Inter | Card title: Cinzel only as a small flavour accent

Use large numeric values for health, energy, and the turn timer. Keep ordinary UI labels in a neutral sans-serif. The fantasy accent font should not be used for rules, chat, or dense information.

RADIUS

12 to 18 px Panels and cards feel polished, not soft

GRID

8 px spacing Keeps the dense game board balanced

CONTRAST

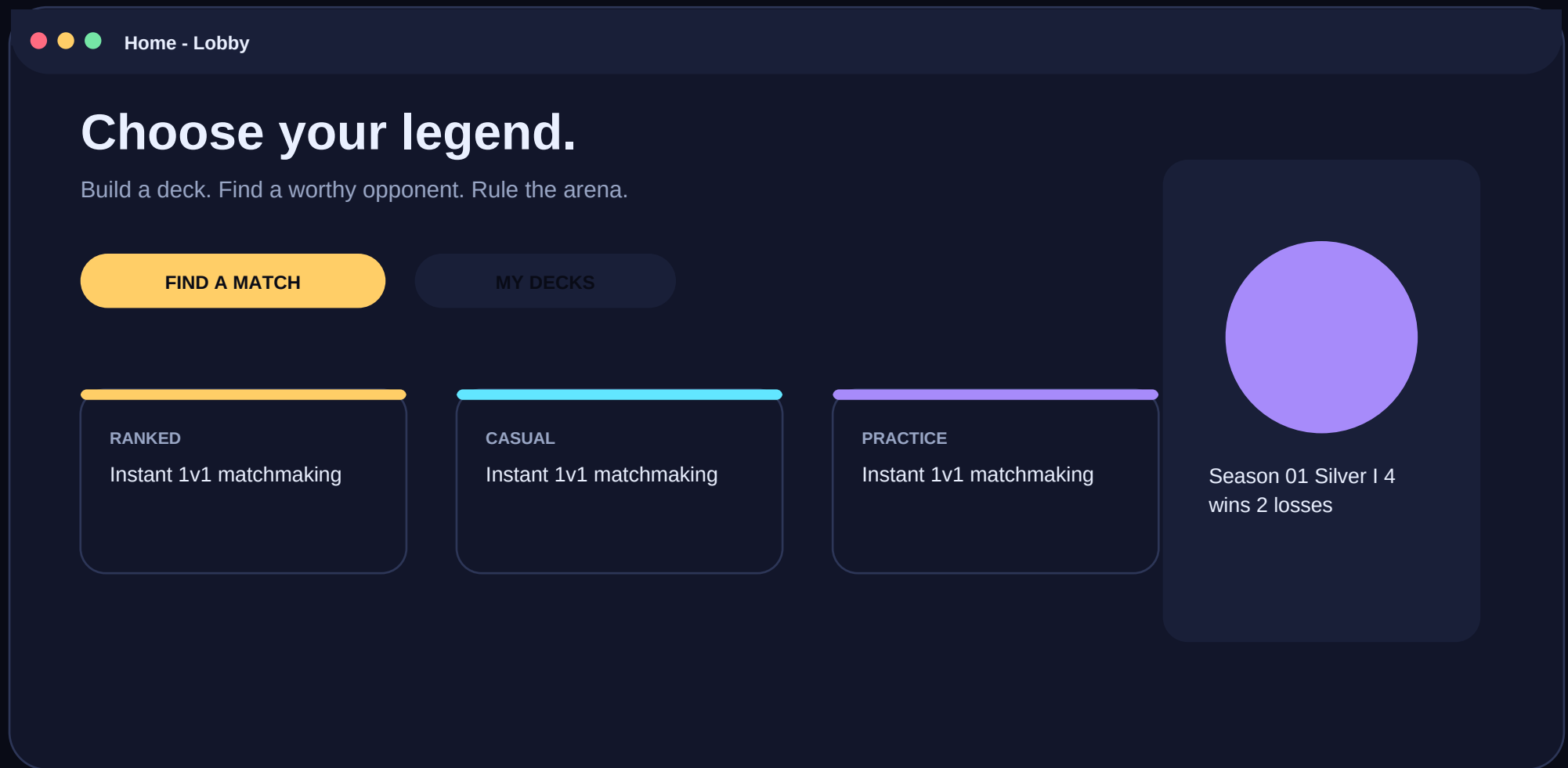
WCAG AA minimum Text and action states remain readable

ICONS

Lucide style plus custom runes
Familiar controls with game character

Home and matchmaking lobby

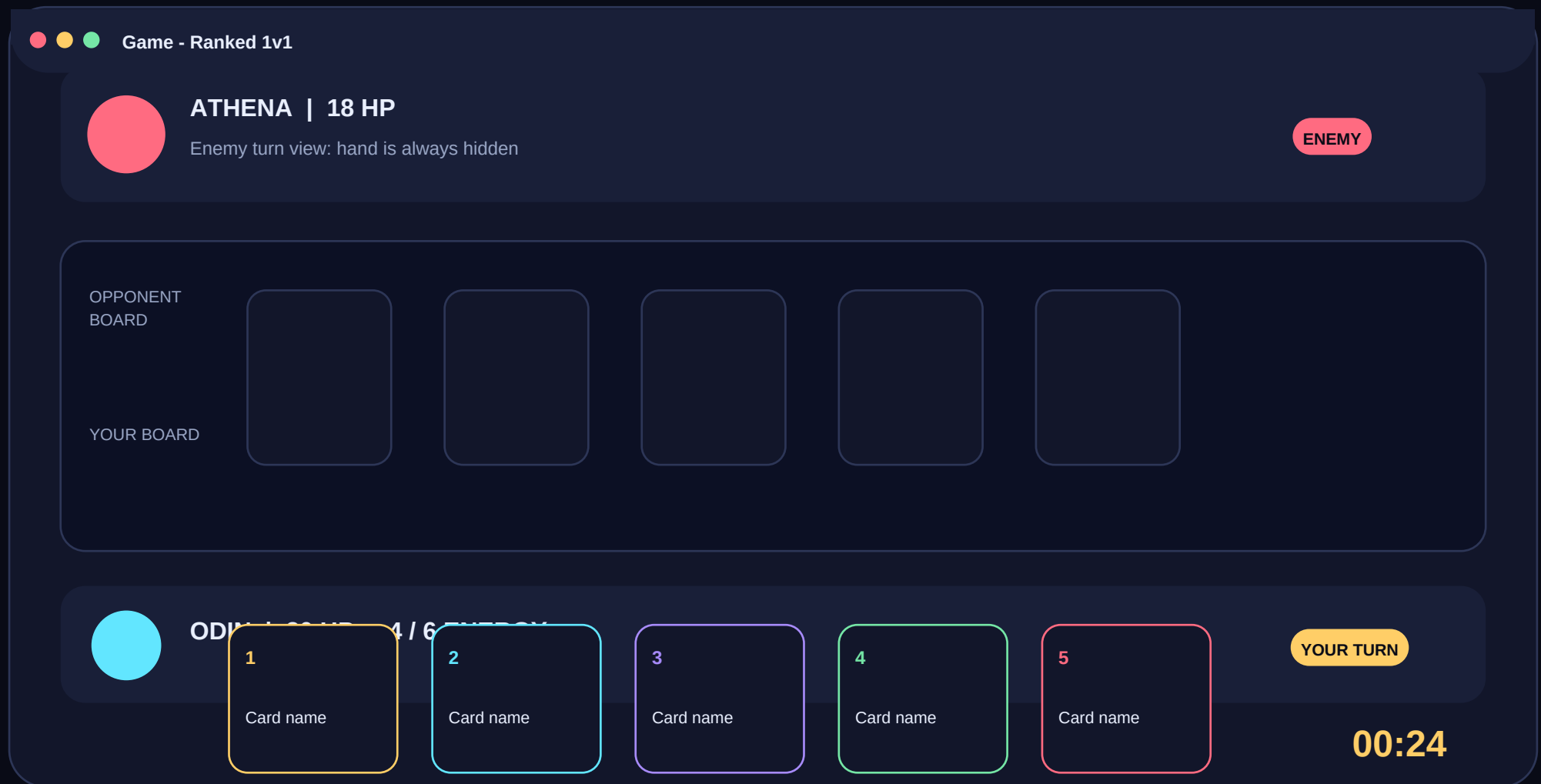
A cinematic entry point that makes the game feel valuable before a match begins.



Motion: a slow ambient glow and parallax background; buttons respond in 120 to 160 ms. Do not autoplay heavy video in the lobby.

Battle board

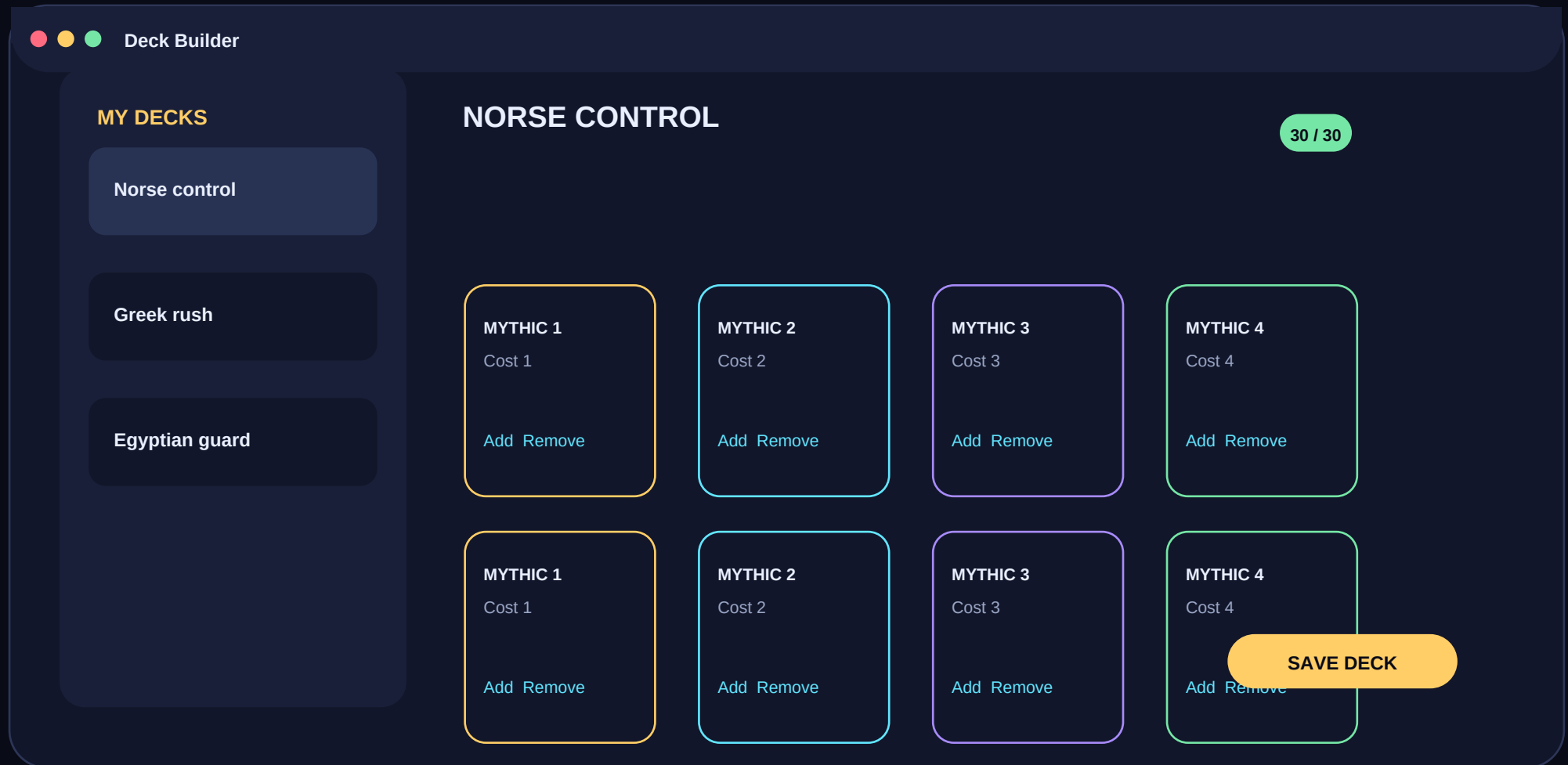
The central UX decision: show the full game state at a glance without visual noise.



Layout rule: cards remain in a predictable hand arc. The timer, active turn and energy share one high-contrast status zone.

Deck builder and card inspection

Collection management should feel rich, but every action must remain fast and reversible.



UX rule: show deck count persistently, make add/remove one click, and preview the card effect without losing the current deck context.

The three journeys that must feel effortless

1 Enter match

Lobby -> Choose mode -> Queue -> Match found -> Battle board

Queue card shows elapsed time, Cancel button, opponent found animation then immediate board load.

2 Play a turn

Read board -> Select card -> See legal targets -> Confirm only when required -> State updates

Use target glow, not a modal. Animate card to board and update health after server confirmation.

3 Recover connection

Connection banner -> Reconnect -> Current state snapshot -> Resume

Never hide the problem. Disable actions while reconnecting and show a clear 30-second grace timer.

Cinematic, but never distracting

Use animation as feedback, orientation, and reward - not decoration.

Lobby ambience	Slow particles, halo glow, card float	8 to 16 seconds loop	Reduce motion setting stops ambient movement
Match found	Rune seal forms then player names appear	650 to 900 ms	Skip after first replayable view
Card play	Card lifts, travels, settles; resolve effect after server result	220 to 380 ms	Do not animate rejected actions as successful
Damage and heal	Brief number pop plus health bar interpolation	180 to 260 ms	Avoid screen shake for every small effect
Turn handoff	Timer color changes, board edge moves to next player	220 ms	Sound and color together; do not rely on color alone

Implementation recommendation: Framer Motion for UI transitions, CSS transforms for micro-interactions, and GSAP only for the match intro or other timeline-based sequences.

BUILD RULES

Accessibility and implementation handoff

A portfolio-worthy game should work for more people than a cinematic mockup.

KEYBOARD SUPPORT

Tab through controls; Enter selects; Escape cancels targeting; never trap focus.

COLOR SAFETY

Use icon plus text for turn and status. Cyan and red are not the only cues.

REDUCED MOTION

Respect prefers-reduced-motion. Replace movement with instant state changes.

RESPONSIVE BOARD

Desktop is primary. On mobile, stack status bars and use a horizontal hand carousel.

LATENCY FEEDBACK

Show pending state after a move. Render confirmed state from server response.

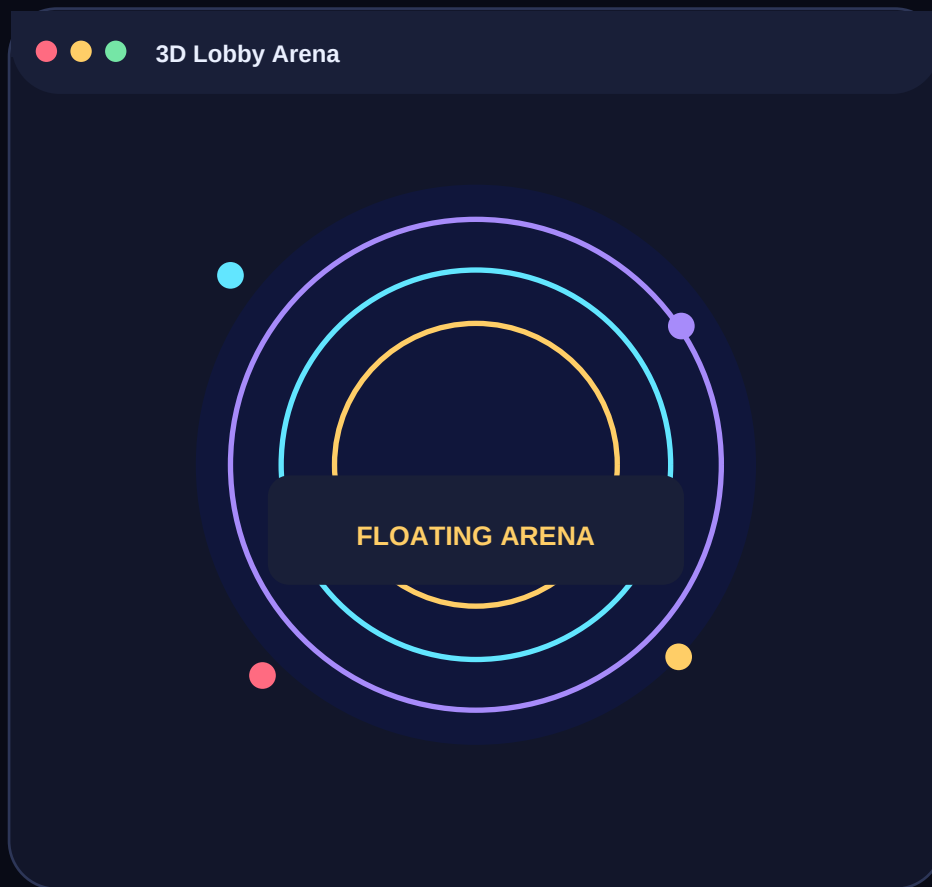
Recommended frontend stack

React + TypeScript + Tailwind CSS + Framer Motion + Socket.IO Client + Zustand or Redux Toolkit + Lucide icons

Final design decision: use a premium dark fantasy lobby, a highly readable tactical battle board, and restrained, purpose-driven motion. This gives Mythic Arena a distinctive visual identity while prioritizing competitive usability.

Cinematic 3D that earns its place

The 3D layer should create anticipation and reward. It must never hide card rules, delay a turn, or reduce performance.



The visual idea

An ancient arena floats in a dark cosmos. Rune rings rotate slowly behind it, with fog, sparks, and light beams creating depth. The camera only drifts a few pixels so the interface stays stable.

LOBBY

Floating arena and subtle parallax

MATCH FOUND

Portal opens, player emblems enter

CARD REVEAL

3D tilt, flip and particle burst

ULTIMATE MOVE

Short summon effect and impact flash

The battle board is 2D-first. 3D enters as a controlled overlay during introductions, summons, and rewards so it feels spectacular without affecting tactical clarity.

3D IMPLEMENTATION PLAN

From a crazy concept to a smooth real product

Build the experience progressively: a beautiful fallback comes first; high quality 3D enhances capable devices.

RENDERING

Three.js with React Three Fiber and Drei. Keep the 3D canvas isolated behind or above the React UI.

INTERACTION

Use pointer movement for gentle camera and card tilt. Do not put essential actions inside the canvas.

ANIMATION

Use GSAP timelines for match intro and ultimate sequences. Use Framer Motion for regular UI transitions.

ASSETS

Use low-poly original arena, runes, particles and character silhouettes. Do not use Marvel, Naruto or FIFA assets.

PERFORMANCE

Target 60 fps desktop. Limit particles, compress textures, lazy-load 3D scenes and pause when tab is hidden.

FALLBACK

Respect prefers-reduced-motion and expose a Graphics Low option. Replace 3D with CSS glow and still artwork.

3D event sequence

Match found -> portal starts -> player crests enter -> arena camera settles -> UI fades in -> both players can act immediately